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Certificate in Financial Planning: Economics majors

Advising one-pager · BS in Economics (Business), 2026-27 catalog · Gatton College, September 2026

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/pathways

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of \$105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Every course requires **60 completed credit hours**: most students start as juniors, and students with AP or dual credit can often start as sophomores.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	For an Economics major
Fundamentals	FIN 350 (or ACC 356, if already taken)	Fall, spring	free elective
Tax	ACC 407 or ACC 357	ACC 407: fall, spring. ACC 357: fall only	free elective
Investment	FIN 357	Spring only	free elective
Estate	ACC 457	Fall, spring	free elective
Retirement	FIN 358	Fall only, no alternate course	free elective
Capstone	FIN 359	Fall, spring; taken last	free elective

FIN 410 also satisfies Investment but requires ACC 301, which is not in the Economics plan, so FIN 357 is the investment course.

The posted four-year plan, with the certificate on top

Year	Fall	Spring
Freshman	CIS 110, MA 109, UK Core ×3	CIS 111, MA 123, UK Core ×3
Sophomore	AN 105, ACC 200, ECO 201, STA 296, MKT 300, <i>elective</i>	ECO 202, ACC 201, MGT 301, MA 162, <i>elective</i>
Junior	ECO 401, FIN 300, ECO 391, FIN 350 , ACC 407	ECO 402, AN 300, MGT 340, CIS 300, FIN 357
Senior	ECO 300-level ×3, FIN 358 , ACC 457	ECO 400-level ×2, FIN 359 , <i>elective</i>

Pathway course **Counts for pathway and major ✓** Major requirement UK Core, electives *Italic = recommended* **One term only**

The certificate takes **six of the plan's nine electives**. Junior spring has no elective and FIN 357 runs only in spring, so move that term's ECO 300-level course to senior fall, where the plan already has two, and put FIN 357 in its place.

Three things to know

1. **It fits in the electives.** Six of nine, with three still open.
2. **Take FIN 358 in a fall, and never leave it for last.** It has no second term and no substitute, so a student who starts in senior spring, or reaches that term without it, cannot finish before graduating (Executive Education afterward costs \$895 a course).
3. **Plan FIN 357 for a spring before the last term.** It is the only investment course open to Economics majors and runs only in spring, and FIN 359 comes after it.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. The experience requirement (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can both be finished after the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student: it needs no sponsoring firm and is not required for the CFP.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning. Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning-wip, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam. ECO 300-level and 400-level: upper-level economics courses the major requires; which ones, and in which term, is flexible.

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Plan: posted 2026-27 Economics (Business) sample curriculum; the catalog year a student entered under governs.